
EMPLOYEE HANDBOOK

Version 3 — Effective July 1, 2026

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A Message from the CEO

Colleagues,

When we founded Troutly Analytics in 2019, three of us sat in a rented conference room and argued for two hours about how to phrase our first customer contract. We cared, even then, about words that mean what they say. This handbook is written in that spirit.

You are receiving Version 3 because on July 1, 2026 we moved our people and payroll operations onto a new human resources information system, changed our pay frequency to biweekly, and re-anchored our paid time off program on a service-anniversary framework. Those three changes touch nearly every policy in the book, so we rewrote the book rather than patch it.

Two commitments I want to underline personally.

First, the signed document rules. If a payroll record, a wiki page, or a system report ever disagrees with a compensation letter you signed and I countersigned, the letter you signed governs until the record is corrected. Bring the discrepancy to People Operations and it will be fixed.

Second, Texas is our only jurisdiction and Texas law is not a suggestion. Your wages are your wages. We do not net, offset, deduct, or hold them back except where the law or a written authorization from you allows.

Read Section 15 carefully and return the signed acknowledgment. If any provision here is unclear, contact People Operations at anjelina@troutlyanalytics.com or (512) 555-0142. Nothing in this handbook creates a contract of employment; employment at Troutly Analytics remains at-will.

Thank you for the work you do.

/s/ Michael Labeson

Michael Labeson

Chief Executive Officer and Co-founder

Troutly Analytics, Inc.

Date: 06/26/2026

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This handbook contains twenty-eight numbered pages, inclusive of the cover, this Table of Contents, and the Appendices.

Revision History

Version	Effective Date	Summary of Changes	Approved By
v1	01/01/2020	Initial handbook issued at Company formation.	M. Labeson, CEO
v2	03/01/2024	Expanded benefits section; added remote-work policy; updated timekeeping and expense procedures.	M. Labeson, CEO
v3	07/01/2026	Full rewrite. Migrated to new HRIS; changed pay frequency from semi-monthly to biweekly; re-anchored PTO accrual on service-anniversary framework (Section 7); revised wage-withholding policy for Texas Payday Law compliance (Section 11.4); added AI and third-party services policy (Section 13.6); added Support Specialist step-increase language (Section 5.4).	M. Labeson, CEO

How to Use This Handbook

This handbook is organized in fifteen numbered sections followed by two appendices. Sections 1 through 6 describe the employment relationship and its administration; Sections 7 through 9 describe the Company's leave, time-off, and benefits programs; Sections 10 through 14 describe conduct, separation, and process obligations; and Section 15 contains the acknowledgment each employee is asked to sign and return.

Terms in **bold** are defined where they first appear or in the policy section that governs them. Cross-references (e.g., "Section 7.4") point to the section that controls in the event of a conflict. Where this handbook and a plan document conflict, the plan document controls; where this handbook and a signed compensation letter conflict, the signed letter controls until the record is corrected.

Questions about any policy in this handbook are directed to People Operations at anjelina@troutlyanalytics.com or (512) 555-0142.

Section 1 — Welcome and Purpose

1.1 About Troutly Analytics

Troutly Analytics, Inc. is a Delaware corporation with its principal place of business at 2405 South Congress Avenue, Austin, Texas 78704. The Company was founded in 2019 and builds subscription analytics software for mid-sized e-commerce brands. All employees of the Company work under Texas law.

1.2 Purpose of this Handbook

This Employee Handbook, Version 3 (HB-V3-2026), describes the personnel policies, benefits programs, and standards of conduct that govern the employment relationship between Troutly Analytics, Inc. and its employees, effective 07/01/2026. It supersedes all prior handbook versions and all inconsistent unwritten practices.

1.3 Relationship to Other Documents

The Company issues dated policy memos from time to time. A dated policy memo governs the handbook section it replaces from its stated effective date until this handbook is next revised. Signed compensation letters and amendments governed to individual employees prevail over general handbook provisions where the two conflict. Informational materials — including intranet pages, wiki articles, and internally circulated summaries — do not create or modify policy.

1.4 At-Will Employment

Employment with Troutly Analytics is at-will. Either the employee or the Company may end the employment relationship at any time, with or without cause and with or without notice, subject to applicable law. No manager, officer, or representative of the Company has authority to alter the at-will nature of employment except in a writing signed by the Chief Executive Officer.

1.5 Equal Employment Opportunity

Troutly Analytics provides equal employment opportunity to all employees and applicants without regard to race, color, religion, sex, national origin, age, disability, genetic information, veteran status, sexual orientation, gender identity, pregnancy, or any other characteristic protected by federal, state, or local law.

1.6 Reasonable Accommodation

Applicants and employees with disabilities may request reasonable accommodation by contacting the Head of People. Requests are handled through an interactive process and are documented in the employee's personnel file.

Section 2 — Employment Classifications

2.1 Regular Full-Time

A regular full-time employee is a Company employee whose regularly scheduled work is 30 or more hours per week on a continuing basis. Regular full-time employees are eligible for the full benefits program described in Section 9 subject to plan-specific eligibility waiting periods.

2.2 Regular Part-Time

A regular part-time employee is a Company employee whose regularly scheduled work is fewer than 30 hours per week on a continuing basis. Regular part-time employees accrue paid time off pro-rata to scheduled hours and are eligible for benefits only where the applicable plan document extends coverage below 30 hours per week.

2.3 Exempt and Non-Exempt

Employees are classified as exempt or non-exempt under the Fair Labor Standards Act based on job duties and compensation. Non-exempt employees are eligible for overtime pay as required by applicable law. Classification is set by the Company at hire, reviewed on promotion, and recorded in the HRIS.

2.4 Independent Contractors

Independent contractors are engaged under a written engagement letter and are not employees of the Company. Contractors are not eligible for employee benefits, paid time off, sick leave, or any policy in this handbook that applies to employees. Contractor engagements are administered by Finance, not by People Operations.

2.5 Change in Classification

A change in an employee's classification, whether a change in scheduled hours, exempt status, or full-time / part-time status, is documented on a Schedule Change form signed by the employee's manager and the Head of People. The change takes effect on the date stated on the signed form. Benefits eligibility resulting from a change in classification is governed by Section 9.

Section 3 — Employment Records

3.1 Personnel File

The Company maintains a personnel file for each employee. The file contains the signed offer letter, signed amendments, tax and identification forms, benefit enrollment and change forms, performance reviews, disciplinary records if any, training records, and separation documents. Employees may request to review their own personnel file by contacting People Operations; reasonable inspection will be arranged during business hours.

3.2 System of Record

The HRIS is the human resources system of record. Where a system record and a signed compensation document disagree, the signed document governs until the record is corrected. Wiki pages are informational and not policy.

3.3 Responsibility to Update Information

Employees are responsible for keeping their personal information current in the HRIS, including legal name, home address, telephone number, emergency contact, and direct-deposit banking information. Changes affecting tax withholding are made by submitting a revised Form W-4 to People Operations.

3.4 Confidentiality of Personnel Records

Personnel records are confidential. Access is limited to the employee, the employee's direct manager and skip-level manager for legitimate business purposes, People Operations, and, on a strict need-to-know basis, Finance, Legal, and outside counsel. Requests from third parties for verification of employment are routed to People Operations and answered with dates of employment, most recent title, and, where the employee provides written consent, salary.

3.5 Retention

Personnel records are retained for the duration of employment and for a minimum of seven years after separation, or longer where required by law. Payroll records are retained for a minimum of four years. Records subject to legal hold are retained until the hold is released.

Section 4 — Work Schedule and Attendance

4.1 Standard Schedule

The Company's standard work week is Monday through Friday. A regular full-time schedule is 40 hours per week. Core hours for collaborative work are 10:00 a.m. to 3:00 p.m. Central Time; individual teams may set additional expectations consistent with business needs.

4.2 Remote and Hybrid Work

The Company supports remote and hybrid work arrangements. Employees whose role permits remote work may work from a location within the state of Texas after obtaining written approval from their manager. Work performed from a location outside the state of Texas requires prior written approval from the Head of People and may be denied where tax, benefits, or employment-law implications make the arrangement impractical.

4.3 Meal and Rest Periods

Non-exempt employees who work more than six hours in a workday are provided an unpaid meal period of at least thirty minutes and are relieved of all duties during that period. Non-exempt employees are permitted reasonable paid rest breaks during the workday.

4.4 Timekeeping

Non-exempt employees are required to record daily start time, meal period, and end time in the timekeeping system by the end of each pay period. Managers review and approve time entries before payroll processing. Falsification of time records is a violation of this handbook and grounds for discipline up to and including termination.

4.5 Attendance

Employees are expected to be at work as scheduled. Absences other than approved paid time off, approved leave, or a bona fide unforeseen circumstance are addressed by the employee's manager and, where necessary, People Operations.

Section 5 — Compensation

5.1 Pay Frequency

Effective 07/01/2026, the Company pays employees on a biweekly basis. Pay periods are two consecutive workweeks beginning Monday and ending the second Sunday. The payroll check date is the Friday following the close of the pay period, except that where the check date falls on a Company-observed holiday, the check date is advanced to the immediately preceding business day. For salaried employees, the pay-period gross equals the annual base salary divided by the number of pay periods in the year.

5.2 Pay Method

Payroll is delivered by direct deposit to a bank account of the employee's designation. Employees may update direct-deposit banking information in the HRIS at any time; changes take effect no later than the second regular payroll following submission.

5.3 Salary Change Authority

Base salary changes require a written approval signed by the manager and the CEO or CTO. The written approval identifies the employee by name and Employee ID, states the current base salary, states the new base salary, states the effective date, and is retained in the employee's personnel file. Salary changes take effect no earlier than the effective date stated on the signed approval. Verbal instructions, email statements, and system entries do not by themselves change an employee's base salary.

5.4 Support Specialist Step Increases

Support Specialists receive an annual step increase of \$3,000.00 on each service anniversary. The step increase takes effect on the anniversary date and is reflected in the payroll for the pay period containing that date. The step increase does not require a separately signed salary-change approval; the anniversary itself is the trigger, and People Operations processes the change in the HRIS. Where the Support Specialist role is changed to a different role before the anniversary, the step increase does not apply for that year.

Section 5 — Compensation (continued)

5.5 Overtime

Non-exempt employees are paid at one and one-half times the regular rate for hours worked over forty in a workweek, consistent with the Fair Labor Standards Act. Overtime must be authorized in advance by the employee's manager. Working unauthorized overtime is grounds for discipline but does not relieve the Company of the obligation to pay for time worked.

5.6 Bonuses and Sign-On Payments

Discretionary bonuses, retention payments, and sign-on bonuses, where offered, are described in a signed offer letter, amendment, or bonus letter. A sign-on bonus stated in an offer letter is paid in the first regular payroll following the employee's start date unless the offer letter provides otherwise. Repayment provisions, where applicable, are stated in the same signed document.

5.7 Pay Statements

Each payroll cycle, employees receive an electronic pay statement showing gross wages, taxes withheld, other deductions, and net pay. Employees are expected to review each statement and to report any discrepancy to People Operations within thirty days.

Section 6 — Performance Reviews

6.1 Annual Review Cycle

The Company conducts a formal performance review for each regular employee once per year on the calendar cycle set by People Operations. The current cycle opens in February and closes at the end of March; managers deliver written reviews and calibrated ratings during that window.

6.2 Mid-Year Check-In

Managers conduct a documented mid-year check-in in July or August covering progress against goals, development priorities, and any adjustments to expectations.

6.3 Rating Scale

Reviews use a four-point rating scale: Exceeds Expectations, Meets Expectations, Developing, and Not Meeting Expectations. Ratings are calibrated across each department by the Head of People before delivery.

6.4 Development Plans

An employee rated Not Meeting Expectations is placed on a written development plan by the manager, with the concurrence of the Head of People. The plan states the specific behaviors and results required, the resources the Company will provide, and the review dates. Failure to meet the plan may result in termination of employment.

6.5 Reviews and Compensation

Ratings inform but do not determine compensation decisions. All base salary changes are governed by Section 5.3.

Section 7 — Paid Time Off

7.1 Accrual

The Company provides paid time off (PTO) to regular employees under the terms of the current PTO Policy Cutover Memo dated 06/20/2026 and effective 07/01/2026, which is incorporated into this handbook by reference. PTO accrues each biweekly pay period at a rate equal to the employee's annual tier divided by the number of pay periods in the year. Accrual is credited at the close of the pay period.

7.2 Tiers

Annual PTO tiers are determined by the employee's completed years of service measured from the employee's adjusted service date and are as follows: 80 hours per year for employees with less than two years of service, 120 hours per year for employees with two years but less than five years of service, and 160 hours per year for employees with five or more years of service. A tier change takes effect in the pay period containing the service anniversary. The new accrual rate applies to that pay period and each subsequent pay period at that tier.

7.3 Liability Measurement

For financial reporting and internal reconciliation, PTO liability is measured at the tier in effect on the measurement date and is valued at the pay rate recorded in the payroll system of record on that date. Hourly rate for salaried employees is calculated as the annual base salary in the payroll system on the measurement date divided by 2,080. Balances are carried to two decimal places; per-employee dollar liability is rounded to the cent, and totals are the sum of the rounded rows.

7.4 Payout at Separation

Accrued PTO is paid at separation only when the employee gives at least 14 calendar days written notice and works through the notice period. Otherwise no payout is owed. Where the payout is owed, the hours paid are the balance recorded in the payroll system of record on the last day worked, valued at the pay rate recorded in the payroll system of record on that date, and paid in the final wage payment. Written notice for this purpose means notice delivered by email to the employee's manager and to People Operations, or a signed letter delivered to People Operations, dated on or before the date the notice period begins.

Section 7 — Paid Time Off (continued)

7.5 Requesting and Recording Time Off

Employees request PTO in advance through the HRIS with reasonable notice to the manager and consideration for team coverage. Approvals are recorded in the HRIS. Time off that is not recorded in the HRIS is not counted against the employee's balance and, correspondingly, does not reduce the Company's measured liability. Employees are responsible for verifying that recorded balances match their own records; discrepancies are reported to People Operations for correction.

7.6 Service and Rehire

Service for tenure purposes bridges across a rehire when the break in service is less than 365 days, and resets to the rehire date when the break is 365 days or more. Where service bridges, People Operations records an adjusted service date equal to the original hire date; where service resets, the adjusted service date equals the rehire date. The adjusted service date is the date used for PTO tier eligibility under Section 7.2 and for any other tenure-based benefit administered by the Company.

7.7 Company Holidays

The Company observes ten paid holidays per year. The holiday schedule for the current calendar year is published annually by People Operations and posted in the HRIS.

Section 8 — Leaves of Absence

8.1 General

The Company complies with all applicable federal and state leave laws. The categories described in this section summarize the principal leave programs available to eligible employees. Nothing in this section limits or expands rights under governing statutes or superseding written policies.

8.2 Family and Medical Leave

Eligible employees may take up to twelve workweeks of unpaid, job-protected leave in a rolling twelve-month period for qualifying reasons under the Family and Medical Leave Act, including the birth or placement of a child, a serious health condition of the employee, or the care of a spouse, child, or parent with a serious health condition. Leave under this section is administered by People Operations; documentation requirements are provided at the time of request.

8.3 Parental Leave

Employees who are new parents by birth, adoption, or foster placement are eligible for six weeks of paid parental leave at 100 percent of base salary, taken within twelve months of the qualifying event. Paid parental leave runs concurrently with unpaid Family and Medical Leave where the employee is eligible for both.

8.4 Bereavement Leave

Up to five days of paid bereavement leave is available for the death of an immediate family member and up to two days for the death of an extended family member. Additional unpaid time may be approved by the manager.

8.5 Jury Duty

The Company provides paid leave for jury duty for the period required by the summons or subpoena. Employees are required to notify the manager as soon as the summons is received and to provide documentation on return.

8.6 Military Leave

Employees serving in the uniformed services are entitled to leave and reinstatement rights under the Uniformed Services Employment and Reemployment Rights Act. Requests are administered by People Operations.

8.7 Personal Leave

Requests for unpaid personal leave of absence of more than five business days are considered on a case-by-case basis by the employee's manager and the Head of People, taking into account business need, tenure, and prior leave usage. Approval is granted or denied in writing.

8.8 Return from Leave

Employees returning from leave are restored to the same position, or to an equivalent position, consistent with applicable law and the terms of the leave program. Benefits continuation during leave is described in the applicable plan document.

Section 9 — Benefits

9.1 Group Health Coverage

The Company offers medical, dental, and vision coverage to eligible employees through the plans described in the current plan documents and rate sheets published by People Operations and the Company's broker.

9.2 Eligibility

An employee is eligible for group medical, dental, and vision coverage if regularly scheduled to work 30 or more hours per week. Coverage takes effect on the first day of the month following 30 days of eligible employment. A change in scheduled hours that first brings the employee to the 30-hour threshold starts a new 30-day eligibility measurement beginning on the effective date of the schedule change.

9.3 Employer Contribution

The company pays 80 percent of the employee-only medical premium. This employer contribution is applied at the same dollar amount to every enrollment tier; the employee is responsible for the balance of the premium at the tier elected. Dental and vision employer contributions, where offered, are stated in the applicable rate sheet.

9.4 Enrollment Tiers

The medical, dental, and vision plans offer four enrollment tiers: Employee Only, Employee plus Spouse, Employee plus Children, and Family. Tier is elected at initial enrollment and may be changed during annual open enrollment or within thirty days of a qualifying life event.

9.5 Qualifying Life Events

A qualifying life event includes marriage, divorce, the birth or adoption of a child, a change in the employment status of the employee or the employee's spouse, and other events recognized by the plan document. Requests to change enrollment based on a qualifying life event are submitted through the HRIS with supporting documentation within thirty days of the event.

Section 9 — Benefits (continued)

9.6 Retirement Plan

The Company offers a 401(k) retirement plan. Eligible employees may enroll on the first of the month following thirty days of employment. Plan terms, including any employer match, vesting, and hardship-withdrawal provisions, are set forth in the plan's summary plan description.

9.7 Other Benefits

The Company sponsors basic life and accidental death and dismemberment insurance and short-term and long-term disability insurance for eligible full-time employees. Voluntary supplemental coverages are available at employee cost. Details of each program are set forth in the applicable plan document.

9.8 Wellness and Employee Assistance

The Company provides access to a confidential Employee Assistance Program at no cost to the employee. Program details are available from People Operations.

9.9 Governing Documents

In all cases, the plan document, insurance contract, or trust agreement governs the terms of the benefit. Where this handbook and a plan document conflict, the plan document controls.

Section 10 — Code of Conduct

10.1 Standards of Business Conduct

Employees are expected to conduct themselves at all times with honesty, integrity, and professionalism, to comply with all applicable laws, and to act in the best interests of the Company. Employees who become aware of a suspected violation of law or Company policy are required to report the matter to their manager, People Operations, or, where the matter involves senior leadership, to the Chief Executive Officer or a member of the Board.

10.2 Confidential Information

Employees have access to confidential information belonging to the Company, its customers, and its business partners. Confidential information includes non-public financial information, customer data, product roadmaps, source code, personnel records, and any other information not generally available to the public. Employees are required to protect confidential information during and after employment and to use it solely for legitimate business purposes.

10.3 Conflicts of Interest

Employees must avoid actual and apparent conflicts between personal interests and the interests of the Company. Outside employment, board service, and personal financial interests in customers, vendors, or competitors are disclosed in writing to the Head of People before the conflict arises. Related-party transactions require approval by the Chief Executive Officer and, where material, the Board.

10.4 Non-Discrimination and Non-Harassment

The Company prohibits discrimination and harassment of any employee, applicant, contractor, customer, or visitor based on any protected characteristic. Harassment includes unwelcome conduct — verbal, physical, visual, or electronic — that creates a hostile work environment or conditions any employment decision on submission to the conduct. Reports are made to the manager, People Operations, or the Chief Executive Officer. The Company investigates reports promptly and takes appropriate action, up to and including termination. Retaliation against a person who reports a concern in good faith or who cooperates in an investigation is prohibited and is itself grounds for discipline.

Section 10 — Code of Conduct (continued)

10.5 Substance-Free Workplace

Employees must not report to work impaired by alcohol or unlawful drugs and must not possess, consume, or distribute unlawful drugs on Company premises or while conducting Company business. Moderate consumption of alcohol at approved Company-sponsored events is permitted for employees of legal drinking age.

10.6 Workplace Safety

Employees are responsible for maintaining a safe work environment. Unsafe conditions, injuries, and near-miss incidents are reported to the office manager or People Operations immediately.

10.7 Intellectual Property

Work product created by employees within the scope of employment is the property of the Company, consistent with the Proprietary Information and Inventions Assignment Agreement signed at hire.

10.8 Media, Public Statements, and Social Media

External statements about the Company, its customers, or its business are made only by employees authorized by the Chief Executive Officer. Employees writing on personal social media accounts about matters of general interest are asked to make clear that they speak for themselves and not for the Company.

Section 11 — Separation and Wage Withholding

11.1 Voluntary Resignation

An employee who intends to resign is asked to give written notice to the manager and to People Operations, ordinarily at least two weeks in advance, so that transition and coverage can be planned. Notice for purposes of PTO payout under Section 7.4 is governed by that section.

11.2 Involuntary Termination

The Company may end employment at any time consistent with Section 1.4. The termination process is described in Section 14.

11.3 Final Pay

Final wages are paid consistent with the Texas Payday Law. Wages for a discharged employee are paid within six calendar days of discharge; wages for an employee who resigns are paid on the next regularly scheduled payday following the last day worked. Payment is made by direct deposit to the account on file unless a check is specifically requested.

11.4 Wage Withholding

Consistent with Texas Labor Code section 61.018, the company may not withhold or divert any part of an employee's wages unless ordered by a court, authorized by state or federal law, or authorized in writing by the employee for a lawful purpose. Accordingly, the replacement cost of unreturned equipment may be deducted from final pay only where the employee has signed the Equipment Deduction Authorization form, kept in the employee's separation folder, with no other document or verbal agreement substituting for it. Where the signed authorization is not on file at the time final pay is calculated, no equipment-related deduction is made from wages; the Company's recourse in that circumstance is limited to civil remedies outside the payroll system.

Section 11 — Separation and Wage Withholding (continued)

11.5 Return of Company Property

Employees return all Company property on or before the last day worked. Property includes laptops and peripherals, mobile devices, access cards, keys, credit cards, and any Company records in the employee's possession, whether printed or in electronic form. Property is returned to the office manager or to the address provided by People Operations for remote employees, and receipt is confirmed in writing.

11.6 Continuation of Benefits

Employees whose group health coverage ends on account of separation are offered continuation coverage where required by law. Enrollment materials and premium information are provided by the Company's broker following separation.

11.7 Post-Separation Obligations

Obligations of confidentiality, intellectual property, and non-solicitation survive separation as set forth in the agreements signed by the employee.

Section 12 — Business Expenses

12.1 Reimbursable Business Expenses

The Company reimburses employees for reasonable and necessary expenses incurred in the ordinary course of Company business, including travel, lodging, meals while traveling, ground transportation, and pre-approved supplies or services.

12.2 Receipts and Approval

Itemized receipts are required for any expense over \$75.00. Approval by the employee's manager is required; self-approval is prohibited. Items over the threshold without an itemized receipt, and any item approved by the claimant, are recoverable from the employee. Where a manager is unavailable, approval is obtained from the next level of management; under no circumstance does an employee approve his or her own expense report.

12.3 Non-Reimbursable Items

Personal entertainment, alcohol other than at approved Company events, traffic fines, and expenses of a personal nature are not reimbursable. Where an expense is unclear, employees are encouraged to seek pre-approval.

12.4 Submission and Payment

Expense reports are submitted through the expense system within thirty days of the expense being incurred. Approved reimbursements are paid in the payroll cycle following manager approval.

12.5 Corporate Cards

Employees issued a corporate card use the card only for reimbursable business expenses, submit itemized receipts through the expense system, and reconcile card activity monthly. Personal use of the corporate card is prohibited.

12.6 Travel

The Company's travel guidelines are published separately by Finance and are updated from time to time. Employees are asked to book economy fares on domestic travel and to select lodging within the per-city cap.

Section 13 — Technology Use

13.1 Acceptable Use

Company technology — including laptops, mobile devices, networks, email, messaging, source control, and third-party software as a service — is provided for business purposes. Incidental personal use is permitted where it does not interfere with work, does not consume material resources, and does not violate this handbook.

13.2 Prohibited Use

Employees may not use Company technology to send, store, or display material that is unlawful, harassing, defamatory, or that infringes intellectual property; to circumvent Company security controls; to install unauthorized software on Company-managed devices; or to access customer data outside the scope of the employee's role.

13.3 Security

Employees are responsible for safeguarding Company credentials, using multi-factor authentication where enabled, locking devices when unattended, reporting suspected phishing or compromise to IT immediately, and completing required security training on schedule.

13.4 Monitoring and No Expectation of Privacy

The Company owns Company-issued devices and Company data resident on those devices and in Company systems. The Company may access, monitor, and review email, files, browsing history, and other activity on Company systems for legitimate business, security, and compliance purposes, consistent with applicable law. Employees should not have an expectation of privacy in communications or content stored on Company systems.

13.5 Personal Devices Accessing Company Systems

Employees who access Company email or systems from a personal device must enroll the device in the mobile device management program and comply with the applicable security settings. The Company may remotely remove Company data from an enrolled personal device on separation or where the device is lost or compromised.

13.6 Artificial Intelligence and Third-Party Services

Employees may not enter Company confidential information, customer data, personnel information, or source code into a third-party artificial intelligence service, cloud application, or other tool that has not been approved by the Company's security review process. A current list of approved tools is maintained by IT and Security.

13.7 Data Retention on Devices

Company data is not stored solely on local device storage. Files are kept in Company-managed cloud storage so that data survives device loss and is subject to backup and legal-hold policies.

Section 14 — Termination Process

14.1 Manager Coordination

A manager considering involuntary termination consults People Operations before communicating the decision. People Operations reviews the documented performance history, confirms consistency with prior actions in similar circumstances, and coordinates the timing, communication, and logistics of the separation.

14.2 Notice to People Operations

A voluntary resignation is communicated by the employee to the manager and to People Operations. On receipt, People Operations opens a separation folder containing the resignation notice, a checklist of open items, and any documents required to process the separation.

14.3 Separation Meeting

Terminations, whether voluntary or involuntary, ordinarily conclude with a separation meeting between the employee, the manager, and People Operations. The meeting covers the last day worked, treatment of accrued PTO under Section 7.4, return of Company property under Section 11.5, benefits continuation under Section 11.6, and any post-separation obligations.

14.4 System Access

System access is disabled on the employee's last day worked or on the effective date of termination, whichever is later. IT is notified through the separation ticket opened by People Operations.

14.5 Separation Folder

The separation folder is retained in People Operations and contains the resignation or termination letter, the equipment return receipt, the Equipment Deduction Authorization form where signed, the final pay calculation, PTO balance and payout calculation where applicable, and copies of any post-separation correspondence. The separation folder is filed with the personnel file under Section 3.5.

14.6 References

Requests for references from prospective employers are directed to People Operations, which responds consistent with Section 3.4. Managers and colleagues do not provide references on behalf of the Company without People Operations' prior authorization.

14.7 Rehire

A former employee is eligible for rehire consistent with the Company's business needs and the terms of any separation agreement. Where a rehired employee's service bridges under Section 7.6, an adjusted service date is recorded in the HRIS and used for tenure-based programs.

Section 15 — Acknowledgment

15.1 Purpose of the Acknowledgment

Each employee is asked to sign the Acknowledgment on the following page confirming receipt of this handbook and agreement to abide by the policies described. The signed acknowledgment is retained in the employee's personnel file.

15.2 Text of the Acknowledgment

I acknowledge that I have received a copy of the Troutly Analytics, Inc. Employee Handbook, Version 3, effective 07/01/2026. I understand that it is my responsibility to read the handbook, ask questions of my manager or People Operations about anything I do not understand, and comply with the policies described.

I understand that this handbook is not a contract of employment and does not create a contract of employment. I understand that my employment with Troutly Analytics is at-will, that either I or the Company may end the employment relationship at any time with or without cause and with or without notice, and that no representative of the Company other than the Chief Executive Officer has authority to alter the at-will nature of my employment, and then only in a writing signed by the Chief Executive Officer.

I understand that the Company may change, add, or remove policies described in this handbook at any time, with or without prior notice, consistent with applicable law.

I understand that signed compensation documents govern where they disagree with any system record or informational material until the record is corrected, and that wiki pages, intranet posts, and internal summaries are informational only.

I acknowledge that any equipment or property issued to me remains the property of the Company and that any deduction from my wages for unreturned equipment requires a separate signed Equipment Deduction Authorization form as described in Section 11.4.

I agree that if I resign, my entitlement to any payout of accrued paid time off is governed by Section 7.4.

Section 15 — Acknowledgment (continued)

15.3 Employee Signature

By signing below, the employee confirms receipt of the Employee Handbook, Version 3 (HB-V3-2026), effective 07/01/2026, and confirms the acknowledgments set forth in Section 15.2.

Employee Name (printed): _____

Employee ID: TRT- _____

Signature: _____

Date: _____ / _____ / _____

Countersigned, People Operations: _____

Date: _____ / _____ / _____

Appendix A — Contact Directory

Role	Name	Email	Phone
Chief Executive Officer	Michael Labeson	michael@troutlyanalytics.com	(512) 555-0114
Chief Technology Officer	Sora Jackson	sora@troutlyanalytics.com	(512) 555-0127
People Operations (interim)	Grayson Oshimoto, Office Manager	grayson@troutlyanalytics.com	(512) 555-0131
Finance Manager	Krystale Jumawan	krystale@troutlyanalytics.com	(512) 555-0169
Talent Acquisition	Luka Odum	luka@troutlyanalytics.com	(512) 555-0183
Benefits Broker	Claudia Bong, Lampasas Benefits Group	cbong@lampasasbenefits.com	(512) 555-0106
Main Line	Troutly Analytics, Inc.	n/a	(512) 555-0100

All email addresses use the domain **troutlyanalytics.com**. The main office is staffed from 8:30 a.m. to 5:30 p.m. Central Time, Monday through Friday, on days the Company is not observing a holiday. Confidential matters relating to compensation, benefits, discipline, or personal information are directed to the Head of People.

The Benefits Broker of record, Lampasas Benefits Group, administers medical, dental, vision, life, and disability enrollment materials on behalf of the Company and is the primary point of contact for eligibility, claims, and continuation-coverage questions.

Appendix B — Forms Referenced

- Form W-4 (federal tax withholding)
- Direct Deposit Authorization
- Emergency Contact Update
- Schedule Change Form
- Qualifying Life Event Change Form
- Personal Leave Request Form
- Expense Report
- Equipment Deduction Authorization
- Acknowledgment of Employee Handbook

Forms are available in the HRIS or from People Operations. Signed forms are returned to People Operations and filed in the employee's personnel file.

— End of Employee Handbook v3 —

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